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BON VOYAGE BY MARINA

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All Inclusive Guide – Meghalaya, Assam & Nagaland

23 November – 3 December 2025

Experience the magic of the North East — from the Abode of Clouds to the Hornbill Festival — in an unforgettable 11-day journey through **Meghalaya, Assam and Nagaland**.

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Day-by-day itinerary

Day 1 — 23/11/2025: Guwahati → Shillong (approx. 3 hrs)

Arrival & transfer

• Arrival at [Guwahati airport](#). Meet & greet and transfer to [Hotel Air Valley](#) to freshen up while awaiting the second group to arrive from Mumbai. After breakfast, visit the [Brahmaputra Ropeway](#) for a short cable-car ride and panoramic views of the Brahmaputra. Then proceed to [Shillong](#).

Highlights & notes

- Brahmaputra Ropeway: short ride, great first-day photo opportunity.
- En route: [Umiam Lake](#) (Bara Pani) — quick stop for photos and lakeside stroll.
 - 🕒 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM

Lunch recommendations (Shillong area)

1. [Cafe Shillong \(Hotel Polo\)](#)
 - Local & continental dishes; light and quick
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- like chicken momos, grilled noodles & Khasi jadoh
 - 🕒 12 PM to 10 PM | 💰 meal costs ₹300–₹700 per person
2. [Trattoria](#)
 - Pizzas & pastas (good for groups)
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- traditional Khasi dishes like jadoh & doh khleh
 - 🕒 11 AM–9 PM (closed Sunday) | 💰 meal ₹200–₹400 per person
3. [City Hut Family Dhaba](#)
 - Local Khasi favourites (hearty, value)
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Chicken momo (fried), Roasted pepper chicken / smoked roast chicken – featured highlights from their menu, Fish Honey Queen Sauce or Prawns Salt & Pepper
 - 🕒 11:00 AM to 9:30 PM | 💰 main-course dishes range roughly ₹300–₹600

✅ **Overnight in Shillong** — Dinner included.



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Day 2 — 24/11/2025: Shillong — Laitlum Canyon, Shillong Peak, Elephant Falls (local loop)

- Morning drive to [Laitlum Canyon](#) (early start recommended for sunrise/mist photos; ~45–60 min from central Shillong depending on traffic).

Highlights & notes

- [Laitlum Canyon](#) — spectacular valley viewpoints and photo spots.
 - 🕒 05:00 AM–05:30 PM
- [Shillong Peak](#) — city panorama.
 - 🚗 53 min car drive from Laitlum Canyon
 - 🕒 9:00 AM to 3:30 PM (closed on Wednesdays)
- [Elephant Falls](#) — classic three-tiered waterfall and easy walk.
 - 🚗 20 min car drive from Shillong Peak
 - 🕒 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM
- Afternoon: Polo Grounds, [Wards Lake](#), Police Bazaar (shopping & local life).
Evening: local club for dinner & entertainment (optional).
 - 🚗 27 min car drive from Elephant Falls
 - 🕒 8:30 AM–5:30 PM

Lunch recommendations (near Polo/Police Bazar)

1. [City Hut Dhaba \(Police Bazar\)](#)
 - Local & north Indian options.
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Roasted Pepper Chicken, Smoked Roast Chicken, Fish Honey Queen Sauce
 - 🕒 11:00 AM to 9:30 PM | 💰 ₹400–₹800
2. [Bread & Booze](#)
 - Cafe with sandwiches and light mains.
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Chicken BBQ hot-dog, German chocolate pastry, cheeseburger, cheesy corn burst sandwich.
 - 🕒 9:30 AM to 8:00 PM | 💰 ₹160–₹280
3. [Cafe Shillong \(new branch\)](#)
 - Good for groups and vegetarian options.



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- 🍴 Must try dishes - chicken momos & grilled noodles
- 🕒 11:00 AM–9:00 PM | 💰 ₹400–₹800

✅ **Overnight in Shillong** — Dinner not included.



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Day 3 — 25/11/2025: Shillong → Krang Suri Falls → Phe Phe Falls → Dawki

● After breakfast, drive east to [Krang Suri Falls](#) (trek ~10–15 min to the pool). Continue to [Phe Phe Falls](#) and then on to [Dawki](#) (2–3 hr drive total for the day depending on stops).

Highlights & notes

- [Krang Suri](#) — short, easy trek; clear pools for a dip (season/weather dependent).
 - 🕒 09:00 AM to 05:00 PM
- [Phe Phe Falls](#) — photogenic cascades.
 - 🚗 31 min car drive from Krang Suri
 - 🕒 8 AM-5 PM
- Late afternoon/early evening in **Dawki** by the [Umngot \(Dawki\) River](#) — famed for its crystal-clear water; optional boating when river conditions permit.
 - 🚗 1 hr 17 min car drive from Phe Phe Falls
 - 🕒 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM
- 💰 Free; boating costs ~ ₹400-₹800 per boat (for 3-4 people) depending on season

Lunch recommendations (en route / Dawki)

1. **Lake View Restaurant (near Dawki)** — local fish & simple plates.
2. **Dawki Riverside Cafe** — quick bites and tea.

✅ **Overnight in Dawki** — Dinner included.



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Day 4 — 26/11/2025: Dawki → Mawlynnong → Cherrapunjee

Timing & distance

● Morning at Dawki (border viewpoint, optional short boat). Then drive to [Mawlynnong](#) (approx. 1–1.5 hrs depending on route). Continue to [Cherrapunjee](#) (approx. 1.5 hr).

Highlights & notes

- [Dawki border viewpoint](#) — views across to Bangladesh; best in clear weather.
 - 🕒 8:00 AM to 4:00 PM
- [Mawlynnong](#) — Asia's cleanest village, famous for its village upkeep, living root bridges (nearby), balancing rock, and skywalk. A community-run eco destination with strict waste rules.
 - 🚗 1 hr 7 min car drive from Dawki border viewpoint
 - 🕒 24 hours
- Visit the [Single Living Root Bridge](#) (the village has smaller root bridges; the bigger double root bridges are in other parts of the district).
 - 🚗 3 hr 16 min car drive from Mawlynnong
 - 🕒 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM

Lunch recommendations (Mawlynnong / en route)

1. [Mawlynnong Village Community Cafe](#) — local preparations, rice, bamboo shoot dishes.
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Jadoh (rice with pork), Tungrymbai (fermented soybean curry) & local vegetable dishes
 - 🕒 8 AM–6 PM | 💰 ₹160–₹250 for a non-veg meal (vegetarian option ~₹120)
2. [Jadoh Corner \(nearby\)](#) — Khasi rice dishes.
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- traditional Khasi rice-and-pork dish *jadoh*
 - 🕒 10:00 AM–6:00 PM | 💰 ₹100–₹250 per plate

✅ **Overnight in Cherrapunjee (Sohra)** — Dinner included.



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Day 5 — 27/11/2025: Cherrapunjee — Wei Sawdong Trek, Mawsmai Cave, Nohkalikai & Seven Sisters Falls

Timing & distance

• Early morning trek to [Wei Sawdong Falls](#) (moderate trek, allow 2–3 hrs including time in pools). Afternoon: [Mawsmai Cave](#), [Nohkalikai Falls](#) viewpoint, and [Seven Sisters Falls](#) viewpoint (short drives between sights).

Highlights & notes

- [Wei Sawdong](#) — two-tier pools, great for a refreshing swim (seasonal; be cautious after rains).
 - 🕒 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM
- [Mawsmai Cave](#) — easy walk through limestone caverns.
 - 🚗 32 min car drive from Wei Sawdong
 - 🕒 9:30 AM to 5:30 PM
- [Nohkalikai](#) — one of India's tallest plunge waterfalls; dramatic viewpoints.
 - 🚗 23 min car drive from Mawsmai Cave
 - 🕒 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM
- [Seven Sisters \(Nohsngithiang\)](#) — spectacular waterfall, best after rains.
- 🚗 21 min car drive from Nohkalikai
- 🕒 8 AM–5 PM

Lunch recommendations (Cherrapunjee area)

1. [Cloud 9 Cafe](#) — light meals and tea.
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Chilli chicken noodles, pork ribs and mocktail “Nuts for You”.
 - 🕒 1 PM–12 AM | 💰 ₹600-₹800 per person
2. **Local market stalls** — quick snacks and momos.

✅ **Overnight in Cherrapunjee** — Dinner included.



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Day 6 — 28/11/2025: Cherrapunjee → Kaziranga (approx. 7 hours)

Timing & distance

- Long drive to [Kaziranga National Park](#). Check-in and relax. Evening bonfire and dinner at the resort.

Highlights & notes

- Kaziranga — UNESCO World Heritage Site known for the **Indian one-horned rhinoceros** and rich biodiversity. (Park booking & safari slots normally required in advance.)
- 7:00 AM to 4:00/5:00 PM

Lunch recommendations (on the way / Kaziranga area)

1. **Local dhabas along the route** — safe, hot meals (ask driver for recommended stops).
2. [Infinity Resort \(Kaziranga\)](#) — resort restaurant (if checking in early).
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Assamese specialities alongside North-Indian, Chinese & Continental cuisines (buffet style)
 - 🕒 24 hours | 💰 ₹6,000–₹8,000

✅ **Overnight in Kaziranga** — Dinner included.



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Day 7 — 29/11/2025: Kaziranga — Day of the Rhinoceros

Timing & activities

- **Early morning elephant safari** (pre-booked / on a designated range). Afternoon **jeep safari** in a different zone. 🕒 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM

Highlights & notes

- Elephant safaris give close encounters with rhinos — follow park rules and maintain distance. Jeep safaris cover larger areas and are better for birding.

Late afternoon: visit tea gardens and cultural show at [Orchid Park](#).

Lunch recommendations (Kaziranga)

1. [Resort restaurant \(Infinity Resort\)](#) — Assamese thali & local specials.
 - 🍴 Must try dishes- Local Assamese cuisine like fish curry with joha rice, pork dishes with bamboo shoot, plus North Indian/Chinese/Continental options offered in their multi-cuisine spread.
 - 🕒 7:00 AM – 11:00 PM | 💰 ₹250-₹600 per plate
2. **Kaziranga tourist canteen** — simple, local fare.

✅ **Overnight in Kaziranga** — Dinner included.



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Day 8 — 30/11/2025: Kaziranga → Kohima (270 km, ~5 hours)

Timing & distance

- After breakfast, drive to [Kohima](#) (approx. **270 km, ~5 hours** as provided). Stop en route as needed for refreshments and short photo breaks.

Highlights & notes

- Arrive Kohima, visit the local church and bustling marketplaces to experience local life. Kohima sits on scenic hill slopes — light walking recommended due to inclines.

Lunch recommendations (en route / Kohima)

1. **Roadside Assamese/food courts** — recommended for quick meals.
2. **The Local Kitchen, Kohima** — local Naga specialties (fermented bamboo shoot dishes, smoked meats).

☒ **Overnight in Kohima** — Dinner included.



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Day 9 — 01/12/2025: Kohima — Hornbill Festival (Day One)

Timing & distance

• Morning: Kohima heritage walk — [War Memorial & Museum](#) to learn about the Battle of Kohima and Naga history. Post-lunch: drive to [Kisama \(Naga Heritage Village\)](#) for the Hornbill Festival (short drive; festival programs typically start in the morning and continue through the afternoon).

War Memorial & Museum

- 🚗 28 min car drive from the hotel
- 🕒 9:00 AM to 4:30 PM

Kisama (Naga Heritage Village)

- 🚗 29 min car drive from War Memorial & Museum
- 🕒 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM

Highlights & notes

- **Hornbill Festival (Kisama):** a cultural showcase of Naga tribes — dances, crafts, food stalls, and traditional performances. Festival schedules listed daily; main cultural programs in the daytime, night carnival often after sunset.

Lunch recommendations (Kohima / festival area)

1. **Hornbill food stalls** — sample local Naga dishes and tribal snacks.

✅ **Overnight in Kohima** — Dinner not included.



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Day 10 — 02/12/2025: Kohima — Hornbill Festival (Day Two) → Dimapur

Timing & distance

- Full day at the Hornbill Festival (crafts, dances, competitions). In the evening transfer to [Dimapur](#) (drive depends on traffic; ~2 hrs approx). Dinner included at Dimapur hotel.

Highlights & notes

- Second day of the festival — deeper access to craft stalls, tribal showcases, and evening music/carnival events. Buy tribal handcrafts directly from artisans.

Lunch recommendations (festival / Dimapur)

1. **Festival stalls** — Naga cuisine (try smoked pork, axone dishes if you like bold flavours).
2. **Dimapur restaurants**: The Canary (multi cuisine), local dhabas.

☒ **Overnight in Dimapur** — Dinner included.



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Day 11 — 03/12/2025: Dimapur → Airport (drop by 13:00)

Timing & notes

- Morning visit to [Hong Kong Market](#) for last-minute shopping (local crafts, textiles, imitation electronics & souvenirs). After shopping, transfer to the airport for onward flight — drop by 1 PM as planned.

Lunch recommendations (Dimapur / airport area)

1. **Hotel breakfast / packed lunch** (recommended given flight time).
2. **Local noodle shops** near the market for quick bites.
3. **Airport cafe** (limited selection).

✅ **Trip ends — Drop at Dimapur airport by 1:00 PM.**

Confirmed Accommodation

- **Shillong:** Risa Pines



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- **Dawki:** Betelnut Resort
 - **Cherrapunjee:** Royal View Resort
 - **Kaziranga:** Infinity Resort
 - **Kohima:** Charles Homestay
 - **Dimapur:** Clover Homestay
-

Souvenir shopping guide (what to buy & where)

What to buy

- **Naga handloom textiles & shawls** — vivid patterns; authentic pieces at Kisama & Kohima bazaars.
- **Handcrafted tribal jewellery & beadwork** — available at Hornbill stalls and Kohima markets.
- **Local tea from Assam** — high quality; carry in sealed packs.
- **Bamboo & cane handicrafts** — functional souvenirs from Meghalaya & Nagaland.
- **Local jams/pickles (bamboo shoot preserves / chutneys)** — region-specific flavours (check customs for carry rules).

Where to buy

- **Hornbill craft stalls (Kisama)** — best for authentic tribal crafts.
 - **Hong Kong Market (Dimapur)** — last-minute souvenirs and bargains.
 - **Police Bazar (Shillong)** — local woolens and handicrafts.
 - **Tea shops near Kaziranga / Guwahati** — select Assam tea.
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Must-try dishes (local highlights)

- **Naga cuisine:** Smoked pork, **axone (fermented soybean) dishes**, and bamboo-shoot preparations. (Strong, pungent flavours — try a small portion first.)
 - **Assamese dishes:** **Khar, masor tenga** (tangy fish curry), and local tea.
 - **Meghalaya (Khasi) specialities:** Jadoh (rice with pork), tungrymbai (fermented soybean), local river fish.
 - **Snacks & sweets:** Local momos, puffed rice snacks, tea-time cakes at Shillong cafes.
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Travel tips & practical notes

- **Permits & documents:** Check any restricted area permits (generally for parts of Nagaland some areas may require registration) — but the Hornbill & Kohima – Dimapur route is generally open for tourists; confirm with local authorities/agent before travel.
 - **Weather:** Late Nov–early Dec: cool mornings/evenings (10–18°C typical), possible mist in highlands — pack warm layers.
 - **Connectivity:** Mobile signals vary — Guwahati & Shillong have good coverage; remote valleys (Dawki, root-bridge areas) may have weak signal.
 - **Park rules:** At Kaziranga follow all park timings, do not feed/approach wildlife, and keep to safari routes.
 - **Festival crowding:** Hornbill (Dec 1–10) draws many visitors; carry cash for stalls (many accept only cash), arrive early for prime seating at performances.
 - **Respect local customs:** Ask before photographing people in villages; Mawlynnong follows strict cleanliness rules — avoid littering.
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Quick packing list (late Nov / North East India)

Essentials



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- Passport / ID, printed flight & hotel confirmations,
- Light to mid-weight jacket, fleece or warm sweater (nights can be chilly)
- Comfortable walking shoes + sandals for river pools
- Light rain jacket or compact umbrella (weather can be changeable)
- Sunglasses, sunscreen, hat
- Personal medicines, basic first-aid (altitude not high, but carry motion sickness pills if you're prone)
- Power bank, universal plug adapter, extra masks & sanitiser

For festival & village visits

- Cash (small denominations), reusable water bottle, small daypack, modest clothing for village visits, insect repellent.

Thank You!

Thank you for trusting us with the opportunity to plan your vacation!

We hope your trip is filled with unforgettable memories and special moments together.

Remember, we're always here to assist you—before, during, and even after your journey. Just a call or message away!

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